

Placement Experience - Nokia

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About Nokia:

Infinera, a leading fiber optics company, was acquired by Nokia in February 2025. Nokia's optical network solutions provide scalable, secure, and reliable connectivity, enabling operators to support new services and applications while simplifying network operations.

The solutions span across network edge, metro, national, long-haul, and subsea deployments, offering smarter and more automated networks with reduced total cost of ownership (TCO). By supporting next-generation services such as 5G, high-speed packet services (400G, 800G, and beyond), and advanced C+L band solutions, Nokia helps customers stay competitive and transform optical networks into value-driven platforms for businesses and end users.

About the Role (Software Developer):

- Work within an Agile development environment.
- Develop, test, and document software solutions using languages such as C++ and Python.
- Perform analysis, development, and automation testing of software modules.
- Support integration of optical software with hardware systems.
- Conduct basic data analysis and visualization of performance metrics.
- Participate in code reviews and team discussions to adopt best practices and contribute ideas.

Recruitment process:

The online assessment was held at CUIC and had 2 sections.

The MCQ section (45 questions) included Aptitude, OS, OOPS, DBMS, and CN.

1 coding question was asked. **(Topic: Graphs)**

- An array was given where each index i is a node with an edge from i to $arr[i]$.

- The task was to return an array where `ans[i]` has the number of nodes that can be visited, keeping the starting node as *i*.

I was able to pass all the test cases except 1 using a brute force approach (bfs).

Around 25 people were selected for the **Software Developer** role.

The interview consisted of **3 technical rounds** and **1 HR round**. Each round was eliminatory.

The interviews for the 1st and 2nd rounds were face-to-face for some and virtual for others. It was random.

Technical Round 1: (40–45 mins)

- Mode: Virtual (MS Teams).
- The interviewer asked me to upload my resume in the chat, then gave a standard introduction round (projects, strengths, weaknesses).
- I explained my **Data Structures project** from the 4th semester, which used a graph data structure with Dijkstra's algorithm.
- Screen sharing was not allowed, so I verbally explained the approach, flow, and the code.
- Midway, I was asked the difference between **stack and queue**.
- Another problem: Find the **missing number in an array** (range 1 to N+1).
- I asked 3–4 questions at the end.

Technical Round 2: (1 hour)

The interviewer didn't ask about my resume. He directly asked me to introduce myself and explain my favourite project. Again, I explained my Data Structures project. He asked many follow-up questions based on the key terms that I used.

Questions asked:

- Explain your favourite project (DSA graph project).
- How did you store the graph in your project?
- Write the declaration line in which you declared the data structure to store the graph. (vector of vectors)
- To implement this in the real world, what other data structure can be used other than a vector?
- Which language did you use for coding?
- Was the code entirely written by you?
- Write the code that you wrote to store the graph.
- What algorithm did you use to find the shortest path?
- Write the entire code and explain the algorithm.
- He asked me to explain each and every line of code that I wrote.
- Are you familiar with data hiding and other OOPS terminologies?

After asking a lot of follow-up questions, the interview ended well.

Technical Round 3: (Around 1 hour)

There was a panel of 2 interviewers.

The entire round was a pen-and-paper round.

After asking some general questions, the interviewer questioned me about the vector search that was mentioned in my resume.

He asked some basic questions related to the Flask server.

I was asked if $5 > 1$ and $-5 > 1$ are the same or different and to write their outputs.

Given a **linked list's** head with one node connected to its head, my task was to find if the linked list had a loop or not. I was asked to write the code for this and explain the time complexity.

I suggested 2 methods.

Since the test case given to me was the case where the tail was connected to the head, I used 1 pointer and wrote a code. I also suggested the 2-pointer approach to detect loops in a linked list.

The interviewer moved to the next question.

<https://leetcode.com/problems/coin-change-ii/description/>

This is a DP problem. I started explaining it from the recursive solution and moved into the DP solution.

He asked some basic questions about memoization, top-down, and bottom-up approaches.

https://www.naukri.com/code360/problems/sort-0-1_624379

<https://leetcode.com/problems/sort-colors/description/>

I was asked to solve the above 2 questions in the most optimal way. The question was then generalized to sort an array. He asked me to think if I could apply some counting logic here.

Other questions:

- Explain the binary search algorithm.
- Draw the graph for $O(n)$ and $O(n \log n)$.
- Which is better, $2 \cdot O(n)$ or $O(n \log n)$, and why?

Finally, the interview ended well.

After a few minutes, I was called back and asked a few questions from my resume.

Questions asked:

- Self-introduction
- How were your previous rounds?
- What were the rounds focusing on?
- Rank your top 3 skills.
- Are you comfortable working with the tech stack mentioned by the company in the PPT?
- On a scale of 1 to 5, how much would you rate C++ and why?
- Explain your favourite project with reason.
- On a scale of 1 to 5, how much would you rate your Python skills?
- Some logical questions were asked based on my projects.
- What were your team projects and mention your team members' names.
- Apart from DSA, what other roles are you confident about?

Round 4: (HR round, 15 to 20 minutes)**Questions asked:**

- Self-introduction.
- How were the technical rounds?
- What was the overall comment about the previous rounds?
- Are you sure about the role in which you are going to work?
- Tell me about your personal details (family details).
- How did you make yourself better compared to the previous day?

I gave my interview experience about the SAP Labs interview that I did the previous day, and it was noted on my resume.

- Many follow-up questions were asked from this.
- This included: how many rounds did you attend in the SAP Labs interview?
- What was the thing that you corrected to do better for this interview?
- They also questioned me about the hackathons I had attended.
- Joining B.Tech IT, what are the things that you are confident about?
- Finally, they asked me if I had any questions.

Finally, 4 people were offered the role of Software Developer..

Tips for interview:

1. Be confident.
2. Start the interview with a smile and confidence.
3. Explain very clearly.
4. Don't say even a single word if you are not confident about it.

5. If you're asked a question you don't know, it's okay to let the interviewer know you're not sure.

Preparation strategy:

1. I followed [strivers a2z DSA playlist](#) for DSA.
2. Try to practice [leetcode 150](#) and [SQL 50](#).
3. Be consistent in your preparation. Try to learn each and every solution from brute force to optimal solutions.
4. Brush up on core concepts including DSA, OOPS, DBMS, OS, and CN regularly.
5. Discuss solutions with your friends to get clarity if you have any doubts.

Stay positive during your internship and placement season.

Do not get stuck in peer pressure.

Don't get upset if you do not get the company that you wished for.

Be consistent with your preparation.

My suggestion is: **never stop preparing, even if you get your summer internship.**

Remember that every flower blooms only in its season, and there is a season for every flower to bloom. So never lose hope. Prepare rigorously so that nobody who interviews you will think of rejecting you.

For people who are already preparing, great job, you are already on the right track. For people who are not, there will never be a better time than now for you to start. **So start preparing right away.**

Wishing you all the best.

If you have any doubts about the company, preparation, or anything else, feel free to contact me anytime.

Regards,

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